

Common Documentation

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Common documentation

Learner Objective: *Learn about common documentation used in modern networks today*

Description: In this episode, you will learn the common types of documentation used in networks today. Examples we will cover include physical versus logical diagrams, network diagrams, asset inventories, and more.

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- Physical and logical diagrams serve distinct but complementary purposes. Physical diagrams depict the tangible components of a system, illustrating the actual hardware devices, their interconnections, and their spatial relationships. These diagrams are invaluable for technicians and administrators, providing a visual representation of the infrastructure's physical layout, facilitating hardware deployment, troubleshooting, and maintenance tasks.
 - Logical diagrams focus on the conceptual or functional aspects of a system, illustrating the relationships, data flows, and interactions between software and network components. Logical diagrams are essential for architects, designers, and analysts, offering insights into the system's structure and functionality without delving into specific physical details.
 - Cable maps/diagrams are another common documentation component - these are critical for tracing and troubleshooting network connectivity issues.
 - Network diagrams are also critical - these diagrams will often focus on different OSI layers of the network; it is most common to see Layer 1 diagrams, Layer 2 diagrams, and Layer 3 diagrams; remember, these are the Physical, Data Access, and Network layers of the infrastructure.
 - Asset inventory documentation is also very common - this documentation will typically detail the hardware in use, software in use, licensing information, and warranty and support information.
 - Other documentation will typically include IPAM. IPAM, or IP Address Management, is a systematic approach to planning, deploying, and managing IP addresses within a network. It involves tracking and organizing IP address assignments, ensuring efficient utilization of available address space, and simplifying the overall administration of an IP network.
 - Documentation will also typically exist for SLAs in the organization. Service Level Agreement (SLA) documentation in a typical IT organization is a formalized contract or agreement between the service provider and the customer that outlines the agreed-upon level of service, performance metrics, responsibilities, and other terms.
 - Finally, another common documentation component is wireless survey and/or heat map. A heat map document in a modern IT organization visually represents data using color-coding to highlight variations in performance, resource utilization, or other metrics across different components, such as servers, networks, or applications. It provides a quick and intuitive way for IT professionals to identify trends, potential issues, or areas for improvement, facilitating informed decision-making and efficient management of the IT infrastructure.
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Additional Resources:

What is IT Documentation: Types, Examples and Templates
<https://document360.com/blog/it-documentation/>